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Halfway House & Reentry Readiness Kit

A practical checklist for the weeks around coming home.

Reentry is a series of small, concrete tasks that add up to a life. The first weeks set the tone, and the people who plan them do better. This kit lays out what to line up, in what order, so you are not doing it all at once and from behind.

You will not get every box done before you are out, and that is fine. Start what you can now, and work the rest in the first weeks.

Identification and documents

- ☐ Locate or replace your ID or driver's license.
- ☐ Get or find your Social Security card.
- ☐ Get a copy of your birth certificate if you lack one.
- ☐ Keep your release paperwork and court documents in one folder.

The house rules

If you are going to a halfway house or supervised residence, the rules there are as binding as any court order. Learn them fast.

- ☐ Get the written rules and read them the first day.
- ☐ Know the curfew, the sign-in and sign-out process, and the pass system.
- ☐ Know the drug and alcohol testing policy, and what triggers a violation.

Money and work

- ☐ Open or reopen a bank account, and build a simple first-month budget.
- ☐ Start a job search list. Note which employers are open to people with records.
- ☐ Gather your work history and references into one document.
- ☐ Ask about job programs your supervision or the house can connect you to.

Health and support

- ☐ Line up any medication you need and know how to refill it.
- ☐ Find a clinic or provider you can afford.
- ☐ Reconnect with any treatment or counseling required or wanted.

The first two weeks

- ☐ Check in with your supervision officer exactly as required. Federal rules generally require reporting within 72 hours of release.
- ☐ Set a daily routine, even a simple one. Structure protects you.
- ☐ Handle the highest-stakes task first: usually ID, then check-in, then income.

My key contacts

Supervision officer: _____

Case manager: _____

Three people I can call on a hard day:

Sources and further reading: *U.S. Courts, Overview of Probation and Supervised Release Conditions* (uscourts.gov).

This workbook is educational and reflects lived and professional experience. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Laws and procedures vary by jurisdiction and change over time. For advice about your situation, consult a licensed attorney in your state.

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